

Rhythm of a Heartbeat

By

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INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

A bright classroom, in the first half of the day, class is in the middle of a lesson getting paired for their class project. The focus is on the main characters Gabriel, being loud and happy, and then Heaven, in the back writing in her journal. The Students are wearing their school uniforms and are generally peaceful apart from Gabriel.

TEACHER

...these projects are getting assigned groups so don't get your hopes up...

JAMES

I really hope we get each other

man, I don't want anyone annoying

GABRIEL

Hey no one here's annoying you just gotta talk to them for once James.

JAMES

Okay, but even you haven't talked to some of these kids, I mean look at-

TEACHER

Gabriel, you will be paired with Heaven...James will be paired with Matthew...Sam will be paired with..

JAMES

You have to be kidding me! We both got completely unlucky

Students turn their head at James, focusing on Matthew who is upset, and Heaven who buries herself back in her journal.

GABRIEL

No, Matthew is the unlucky one, you really need to learn some respect James

Gabriel walks over and sits down in a desk next to Heaven.

GABRIEL

Hey. I know we have never talked but don't listen to James, I'm more than stoked to do this project with you!

Heaven looks up and smiles against her will, suddenly

appearing to romanticize Gabriel mentally.

HEAVEN (NERVOUSLY)

I'm glad too, when should we start. I mean not that I want to rush you or anything I-

GABRIEL (SMILING)

Heaven. It's okay. What about tonight Around 7? I'll be out of football practice then and we can spend the rest of the evening working.

Heaven, now blushing, shakes her head as the bell rings. She gets up and immediately opens her journal to a section called lyrics, and she writes "Rhythm of a Heartbeat" at the top and begins writing, getting blurred out in the process.

CUT TO:

INT. KITCHEN - NIGHT

Gabriel's mom who is doing the dishes is first present in this scene, Gabriel is then seen rushing in getting ready and spraying cologne catching his mom's attention. Hes wearing a white hoodie and sweatpants, trying to be comfortable while looking good.

GABRIEL'S MOM

What's all this for? Got a hot date?

GABRIEL

Yeah mom, funny. A girl is coming over to work on a school project, don't make it weird.

GABRIEL'S MOM

Oh I see, you should play her some drums, instruments always impress the ladi-

GABRIEL

No. And mom, they impress you. I hate those stupid things why cant you ever just get rid of them.

GABRIEL'S MOM

You do not, speak to me that way, understand? You will play the drums whether you like it or not, I do not care.

A doorbell sounds throughout the house, and Gabriel gives his mom a disdainful look before getting up and opening the door to Heaven. She was wearing an over sized hoodie with her hair in a bun and had clear glasses on.

GABRIEL

Hey Heaven, glad you made it safe!

HEAVEN (TRYING TO HIDE HER BLUSH)

Hi Gabe, may I come in?

Gabriel, smiling, nods his head and leads Heaven in. His mom looks back and smiles at the sight of the girl, however, Gabriel leads her straight to his room down the hallway. They sit on his bed, pull out their laptops, notebooks, and papers and appear to start working.

GABRIEL

So, if it's not rude to ask, why are you always so quiet in class?

He notices shes staring at the corner of his room, where his drum set lays.

HEAVEN

Do you play the drums?

GABRIEL

I. What? Yes I mean I guess I don't really like it its stup-

HEAVEN's face lights up

HEAVEN

Play me something!

BEGIN FLASHBACK: INT. BEDROOM - DAY

Gabriel's mom is seen to be supposedly verbally harassing Gabriel into playing, you can only see neck down as his hands tremble to the sight of his mom being angry.

END FLASHBACK.

HEAVEN

Gabe?

GABRIEL

No.

HEAVEN

But-

GABRIEL

I said no. We should continue working.

They go back to work but, instead of writing on paper Heaven pulls out her computer and begins typing, and clicking, the screen bright on her face, as she actively tries to hide it from Gabriel. She has her journal next to her, constantly looking down before resuming whatever she is doing. Occasionally will stop to help Gabriel so he doesn't get suspicious of her.

HEAVEN

Gabe? Your a drummer and all-

GABRIEL

Not. A drummer.

HEAVEN

Okay, drummer, not a drummer, no matter the case. You know what a rhythm is right? Do you ever wonder if the rhythm of your heartbeat changes when you're with someone you love?

Gabriel sits there for a second, blank faced. He attempts to listen for his own heartbeat, he notices though that the rhythm is not changing, its getting faster.

GABRIEL

I think, it would get faster.

HEAVEN

I think so too. Gabe. Are you sure you can't play for me?

Gabriel gets angry at the question of playing again

GABRIEL

You need to go.

Heaven's smile quickly fades

HEAVEN

What?

GABRIEL

Go. Now!

HEAVEN, scared and confused without thinking gets up and runs out of his room and leaves his house in tears. Gabriel, sits back rubbing his head.

BEGIN FLASHBACK: Int. Kitchen - Night

GABRIEL'S MOM
..you should play her some drums,
instruments always impress the ladi-

GABRIEL
No-

END FLASHBACK

GABRIEL TURNS HIS HEAD AND SEES HEAVEN HAD LEFT HER STUFF. OUT OF CURIOSITY HE LOOKS AT HER COMPUTER TO SEE A MUSIC SCORE. A LONG ONE, COMPOSED OF A PIANO, TRUMPET, BASS, AND LYRICAL SECTION. HIS EYES SCANNED THE LYRICS, YOU CAN HEAR HIS HEART BEAT GOING UP. HE PRESSES PLAY, AND THE SONG IS BEAUTIFUL. HE LOOKS AT HIS DRUM SET AND BACK AT THE LAPTOP, AND FINALLY GETS UP.

CUT TO:

INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

Gabriel walks into the same class as the day before, with Heaven's Journal and laptop in hand. She's sitting in the back of the room with her head down as Gabriel approaches her.

GABRIEL
Heaven, I brought your stuff, you left it yesterday night. I'm sorry that I got mad at you. My heart's rhythm stops at the ones my hands play. I always hated it. I couldn't do it, and so I lost temper. I want you to come back over today, if of course, you forgive me. I have something I need to show you.

HEAVEN looks at him teary eyed, her smile coming through the tears. She grabs her stuff and without saying a word hugs him. He hugs her back and sits down to start class.

FADE TO:

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Gabriel is sitting on his bed when Heaven walks in.

HEAVEN

Hey Gabriel. Your mom let me in, shes really sweet.

GABRIEL

You could say that, sure.

HEAVEN

So what was it you wanted to show me?
Did you finish the project?

GABRIEL

No, but, I saw your song, and wait
before you get upset. I loved it.

HEAVEN looks embarrassed as she looks at him with disbelief

HEAVEN

You...did?

GABRIEL

I did. So much, I did this. May I
borrow that computer of yours?

Confused, she hands him the computer with the score on it, he places it on a small desk next to his drum set and sits at the drum throne. He presses play on the score and proceeds to play a beat to her song. Heaven hearing and watching this, tears up and sits on his bed. Her heartbeat is matching the tempo of the song at first, but it starts to go in double time of the song. When Gabriel finishes he turns around to a crying Heaven who, without anything else to do, hugs him.

HEAVEN

I've never been happier.

GABRIEL

I always wondered why I didn't like
the drums. I always thought it was
because I had been forced too. I was
wrong. It was the sole fact through
each beat I hit on the drum heads that
no meaning were meant behind them. I
understand now though, what it means
to be a musician, to be a drummer, to
fall in love.

Gabriel and Heaven hug and proceed to head back to the bed to finish the project. Once completed they flip her computer open to a production app where they produce the song. Gabriel provided a microphone laying in a box full of cables, wires, and other smaller electronic items.

They proceed to post the song on social media where it blows up over night, as seen by a silent room with a lit up phone being repeatedly hit with notifications. This montage of events is under the song, "Rhythm of a Heartbeat" they had produced.

CUT TO:

INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

Gabriel and Heaven are sitting with each other with kids surrounding them praising them for their new song. James enters the room and walks over.

JAMES

Whoa what is everyone doing around you. I mean yeah your popular but man this popular?

GABRIEL

Me and Heaven released a song, James. I wouldn't have seen us doing that in a million years if we were partners.

JAMES

Anyways. I wanted to say that Matthew and I became good friends, this didn't turn out so bad after all.

GABRIEL

Told you, anything can happen.

JAMES

I hate that your always right man. So whats that song of yours called again?

GABRIEL

"Rhythm of a Heartbeat"

Everyone starts laughing and smiling showing the positive outcome the previous days have bought, end credits are shown with the chorus of their song playing.